

Check Coverage Eligibility

Check Coverage Eligibility- Request

This functionality will be called by providers to check the eligibility of a beneficiary with the payers via NHCX. This feature will be used to request whether the patient's coverage is in force, whether it is valid at this or specified date, and/or for requesting the benefits & plan details associated with the coverage. Providers should send the following details in the request body while making a call for coverage eligibility check:

1. A set of header attributes that provide transport, security, message integrity and summary information about the message being exchanged. This information is used by the NHCX gateway for routing the request and auditing purposes.
2. Domain payload containing the CoverageEligibilityRequest domain entity as prescribed for the use case by the domain specifications.
<https://nrces.in/preview/ndhm/fhir/r4/StructureDefinition-CoverageEligibilityRequest.html>.
3. This needs to be encrypted so that NHCX cannot read and can be decrypted & processed only by the intended recipient. The domain payload should be a CoverageEligibilityRequest document resource as per NHCX FHIR profile definitions (an extension of HL7 FHIR).
4. Request body (header attributes and the FHIR payload) should be sent in the form of a JWE token ([RFC-7516](#)) using the steps defined in the link.
<https://datatracker.ietf.org/doc/html/rfc7516>

The response to this functionality will be one of the following:

5. A successful accepted response from the HCX gateway if the structure of the request is valid and the validation of open attributes (protocol headers) is successful. Upon successful validation, HCX gateway forwards the same request to the intended recipient asynchronously.
6. An error response if any of the validations fail. If the request is successfully accepted by the NHCX gateway and forwarded to the recipient (i.e. the payer), the provider (who made the Coverage Eligibility Request API call) should expect the response via a call back to Coverage Eligibility Response API asynchronously.
7. The response API payload may either contain the requested coverage details or error details in case of any errors during processing.
8. An alternate scenario is when the Payer might respond with a forward instruction asking the NHCX to submit the same request to another Payer.
9. Payer will respond with CoverageEligibilityResponse object upon successful processing of the request at payer systems by calling /on_request API.

Check Coverage Eligibility- Response

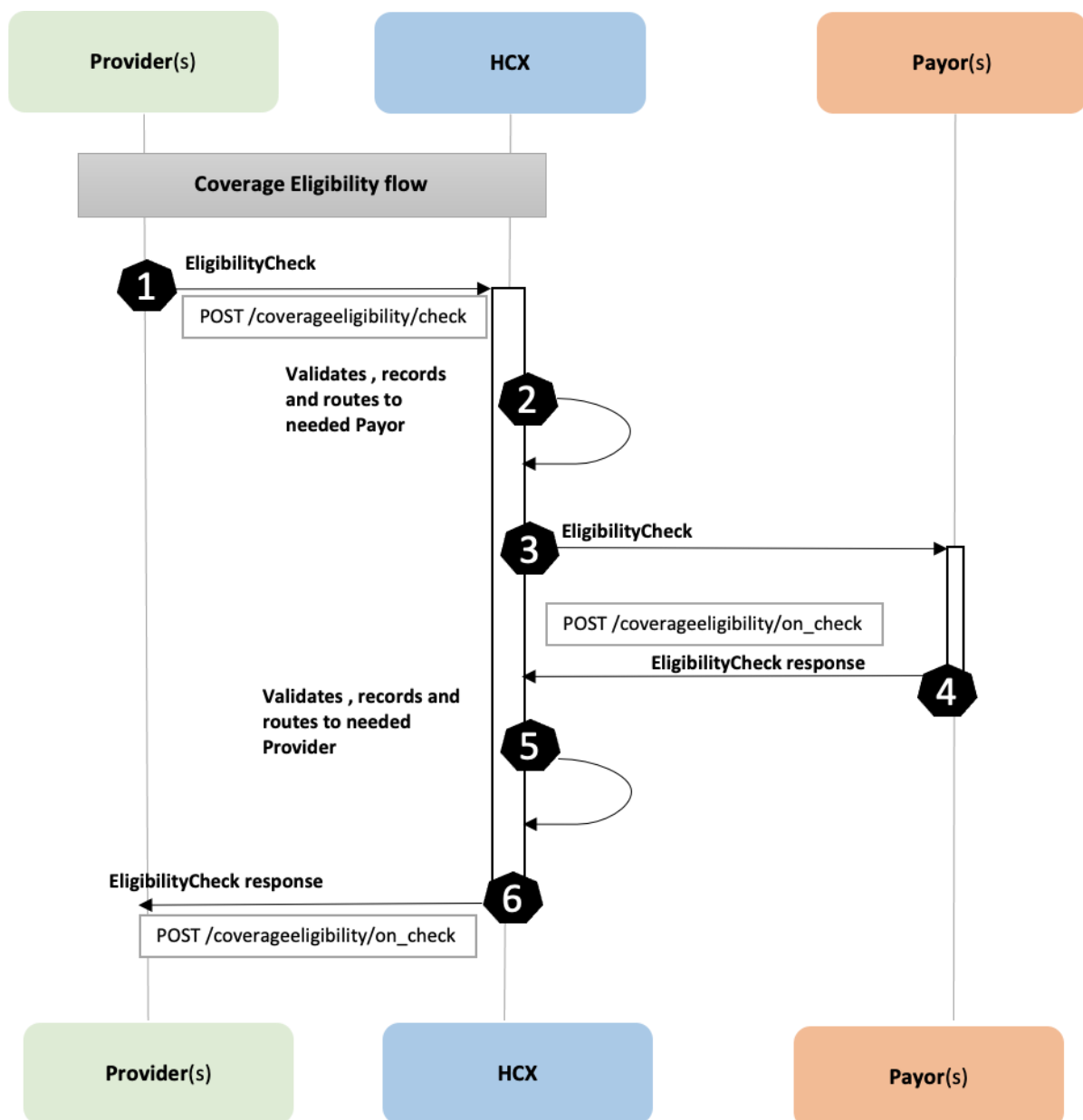
This API is for payers to send the response for a coverage eligibility request to the providers. In case of a successful scenario, this API payload should contain the eligibility and plan details of the beneficiary for whom the details are requested for. Payers should send the following details as the request payload in the coverage eligibility response API:

1. A set of header attributes that provide transport, security, message integrity and summary information about the message being exchanged. This information is used by the HCX gateway for routing the request and auditing purposes.
2. If the coverage eligibility request is successfully processed, payer should send a CoverageEligibilityResponse domain entity as specified for the use case in domain specifications in the link.
<https://nrcea.in/preview/ndhm/fhir/r4/StructureDefinitionCoverageEligibilityResponse.html>.
3. This needs to be encrypted so that NHCX cannot read this, and this can be decrypted & processed only by the intended recipient.
4. In any scenario if Payer is unable to process the request due to provider is invalid or decryption of the message fails or any mandatory protocol attributes are missing with regards to the use case, an error message will be sent as “protocol response” which contains the same protocol header attributes along with error messages.
5. The error details should be sent in the following manner: - Basic details about the error must be sent as part of the header attributes. NHCX gateway shall read and store this information for audit & search purposes.
6. Following header attributes should be used for sending the error details: - ****x-hcx-status**** should be set to ****response.fail****. - ****x-hcx-error_details**** attribute should be set with the appropriate error code, message, and trace details (if available).
7. In case where there are clinical, patient, or business-related errors, the payer should send exact details of the error to the recipient. These details should not be shared with the HCX gateway and hence, should be sent in encrypted form. Payer should embed the error details within the CoverageEligibilityResponse resource that is sent as part of the request body.

Note: Refer to the JWEPayload schema definition for details & structure of the JWE token that must be sent as the request body in this API. The response to this API could be one of the following:

- a. A successful accepted response from the HCX gateway if the structure of the request payload is valid and the validation of open attributes (protocol headers) is successful. Upon successful validation, HCX gateway forwards the same request to the intended recipient asynchronously.
- b. An error response if any of the validations

Sequence Diagram



High-level definitions of API

API Definition - Check Eligibility API - Payer

Name of the API	/coverageeligibility/check
Description/Purpose	This API is for providers to check the eligibility of a beneficiary with the payors via HCX. This API should be used to request whether the patient's coverage is in force, whether it is valid at this or specified date, and/or for requesting the benefits & plan details associated with the coverage.

Input (API to be consumed by)	provider
Key Processing/Validations	Validate benefit id, Payor id and provider id as per the logic.
HTTP Method	POST
External API	
Input JSON Structure	As per the API specification published
Response JSON Structure	As per the API specification published
HTTP Response Status Code	202 - Accepted
Exception Code	400 – Request Validation Failed 404- Request resource was not found 500 – Downstream systems down/unhandled exception
Error Response	As per the API specification published
Any Remarks	

API Definition - Check Eligibility API - Provider

Name of the API	/coverageeligibility/on_check
Description/Purpose	This API is for payors to send the response for a coverage eligibility request to the providers. In case of a successful scenario, this API payload should contain the eligibility and plan details of the beneficiary for whom the details are requested for.
Input (API to be consumed by)	payer
Key Processing/Validations	Validate benefit id, Payor id and provider id as per the logic.
HTTP Method	POST
External API	
Input JSON Structure	As per the API specification published
Response JSON Structure	
HTTP Response Status Code	202 - Accepted
Exception Code	400 – Request Validation Failed 404- Request resource was not found 500 – Downstream systems down/unhandled exception

Error Response	
Any Remarks	